Manchester City 0-2 Liverpool

English Premier League 2024/2025

Match Report

Manchester City - Liverpool, 0-2

Summary

Starting 11

1	Alisson		
4	V. van Dijk		
5	I. Konaté		
7	L. Díaz	▼	79
8	D. Szoboszlai	⚽	
10	A. Mac Allister		
11	Mohamed Salah	⚽ ▼	91
17	C. Jones	▼	74
26	A. Robertson	▼	74
38	R. Gravenberch		
66	T. Alexander-Arnold	▼	91

Substitutes

3	W. Endo	▲	74
18	C. Gakpo	▲	79
19	H. Elliott	▲	91
21	K. Tsimikas	▲	74
78	J. Quansah	▲	91

Starting 11

6	N. Aké	▼	77
7	Omar Marmoush	▼	77
11	J. Doku		
14	Nico González	▼	77
17	K. De Bruyne	▼	66
24	J. Gvardiol		
26	Savinho		
31	Ederson		
45	A. Khusanov		
47	P. Foden		
82	R. Lewis		

Substitutes

3	Rúben Dias	▲	77
8	M. Kovačić	▲	77
19	İ. Gündoğan	▲	77
87	J. McAtee	▲	66

2	Goals	0
0.74	xG	0.79
33%	Ball possession %	67%
7	Shots	15
4	Shots on target	5
5	Corners	7
4	Offsides	2
11	Fouls committed	3
0	Yellow cards	0
0	Red cards	0

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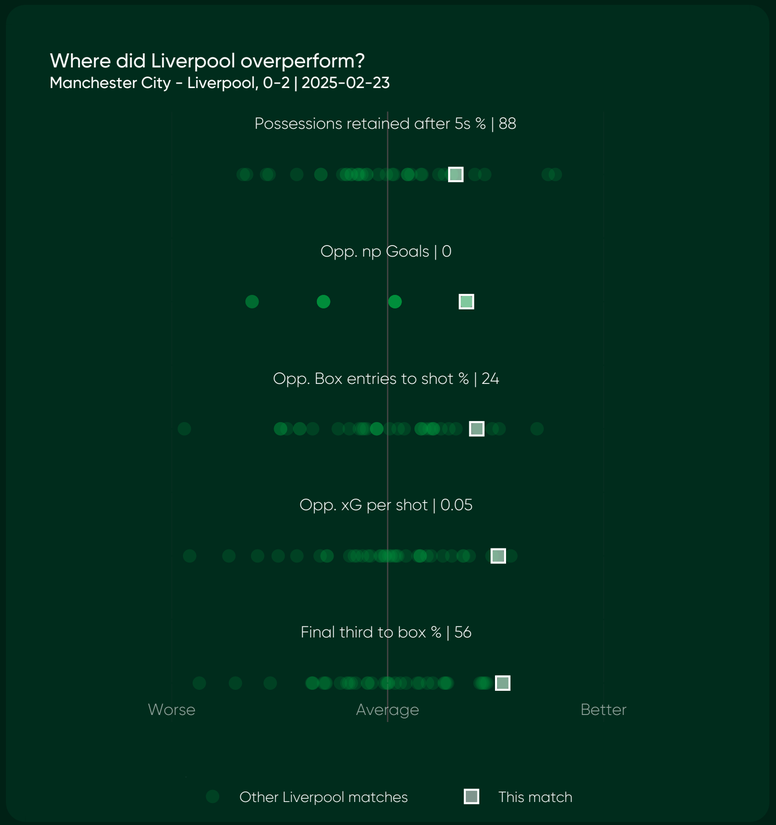
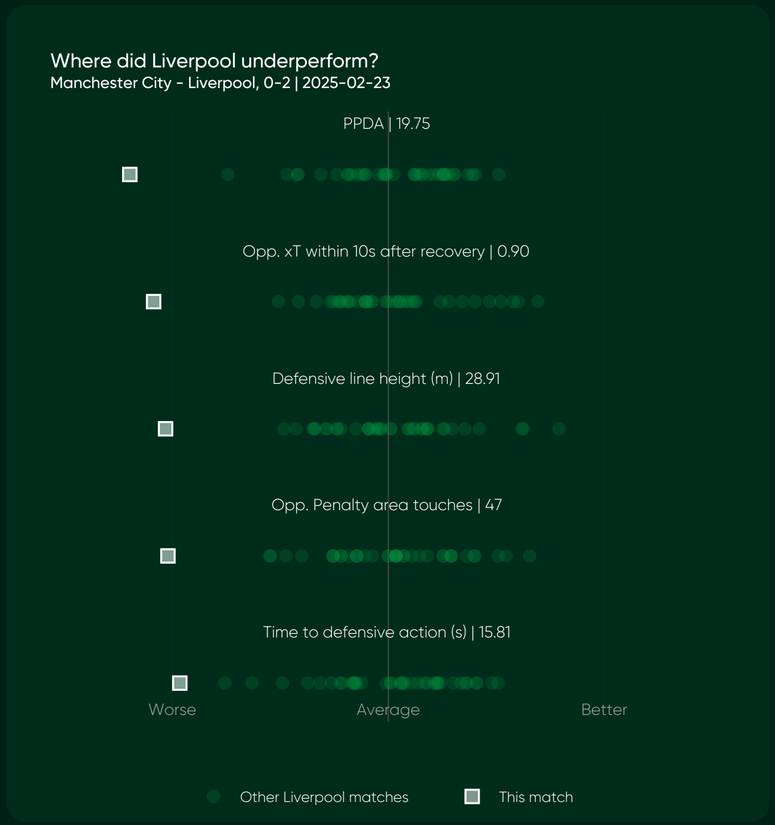
What stood out in the match?





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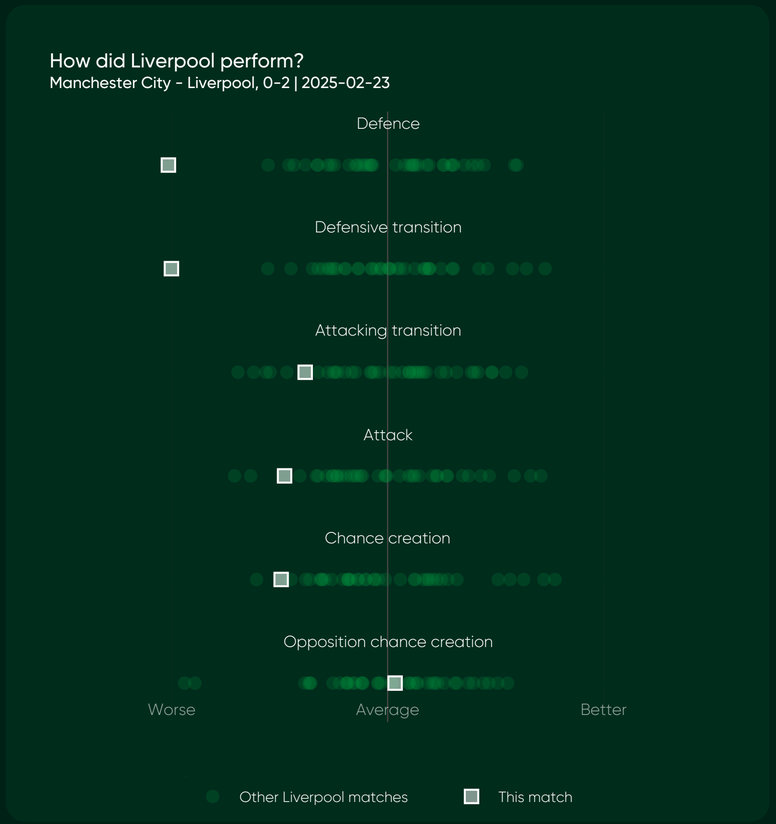
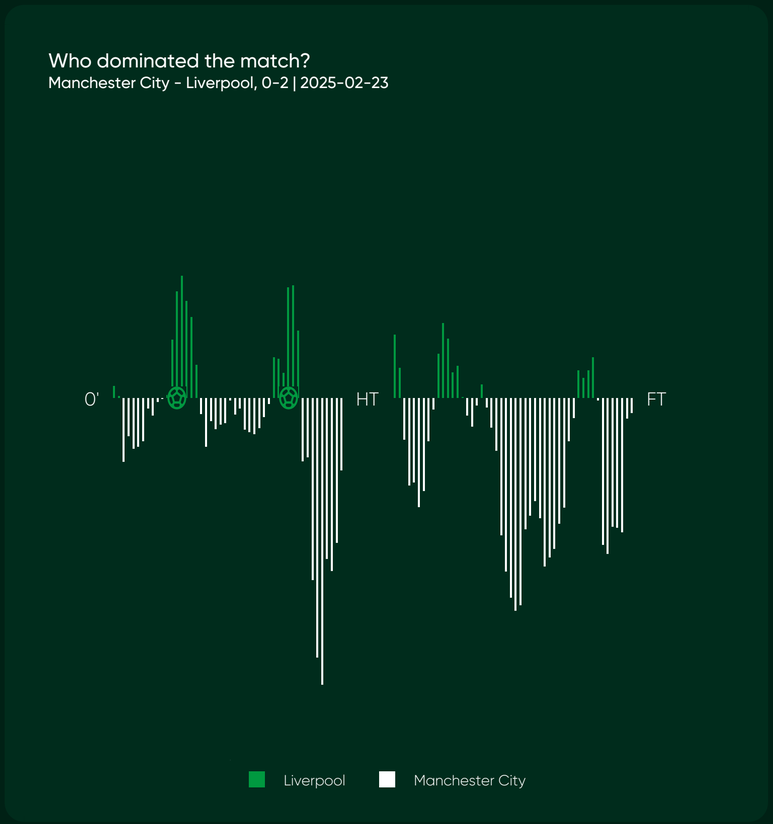
Liverpool's Defensive Vulnerabilities Despite Victory





In their victory over Manchester City, Liverpool's performance was oddly subpar despite the favorable result. They struggled with chance creation, reflected in their very low proportion of box entries that resulted in a shot. While they managed to win the match, they allowed City many touches in the penalty area, suggesting defensive vulnerabilities. Liverpool also faced challenges in their attacking transitions, recovering the ball closer to their own goal than usual, which hampered their ability to counter effectively.

Liverpool had a solid start, scoring two goals in the first half but faced a strong response from Manchester City thereafter. While they maintained a clean sheet, they struggled to retain control as City dominated significant portions of the second half, including the closing minutes and additional time. Overall, Liverpool can take away some positives, but will need to improve their performance under pressure in future matches.

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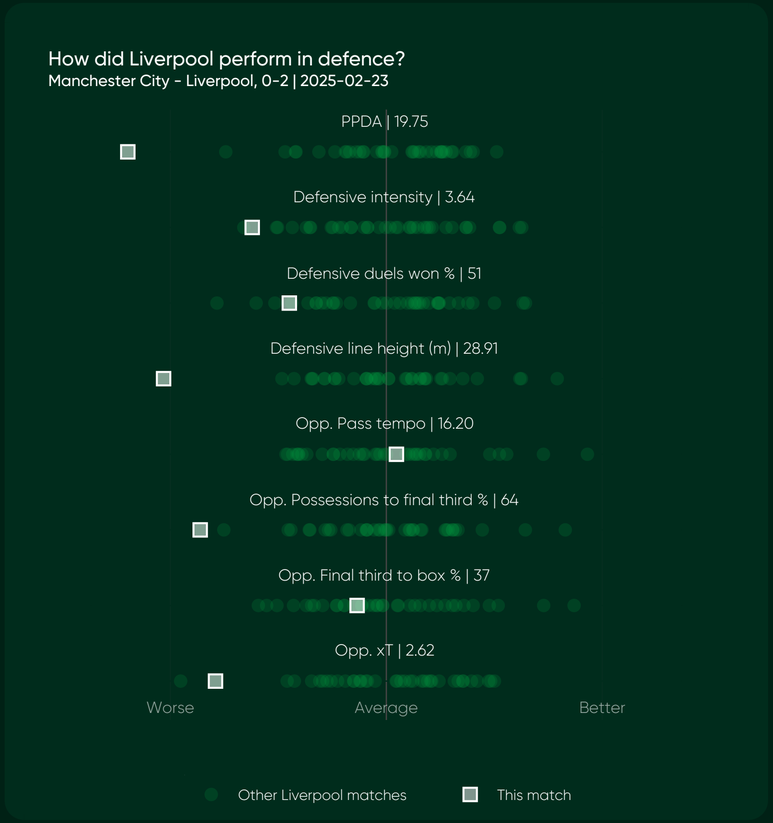
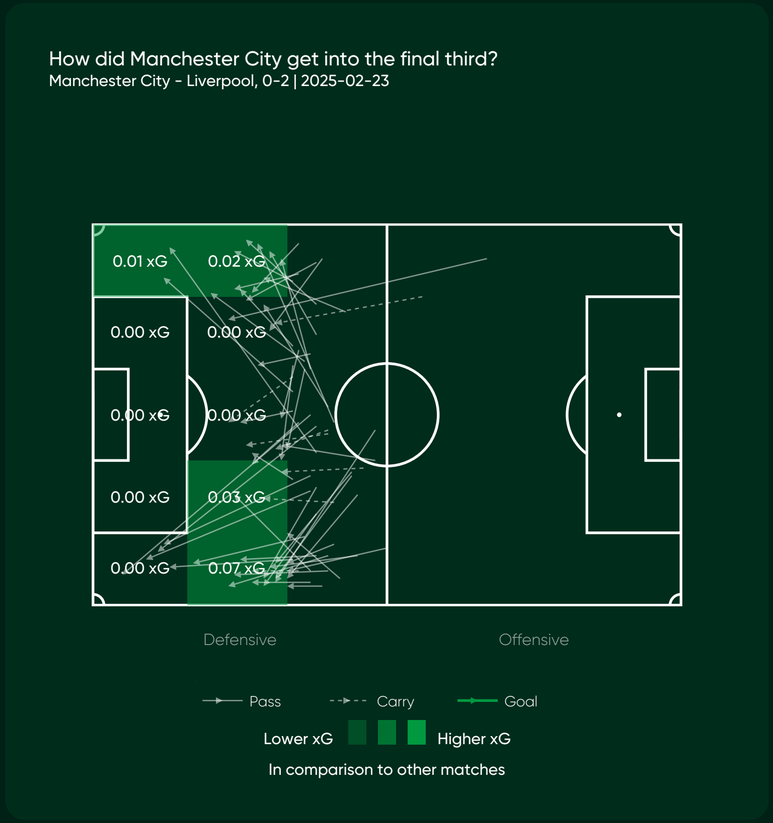
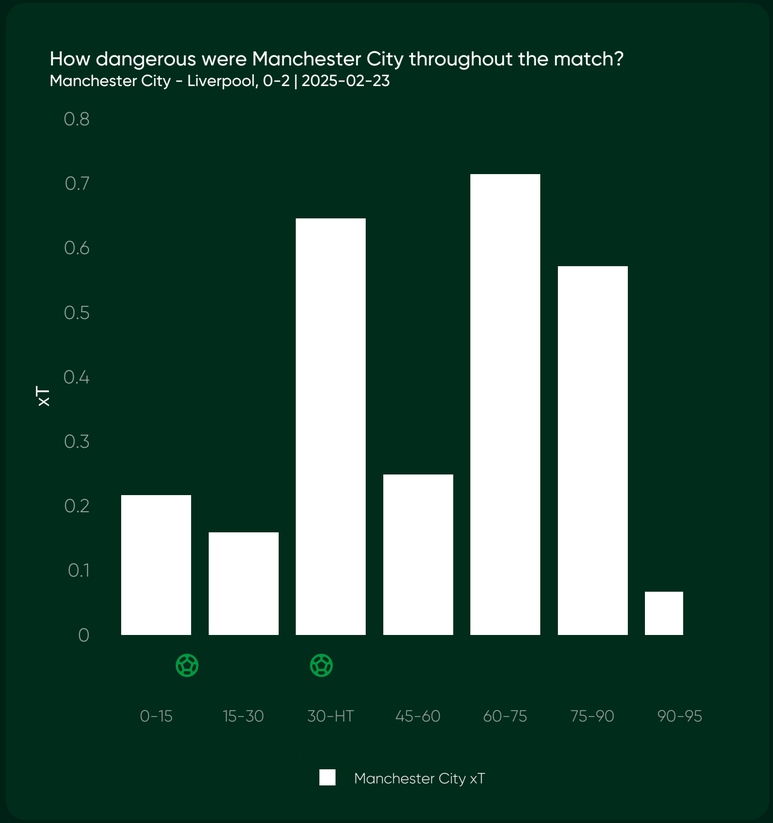
Liverpool's Defensive Performance Raises Concerns







While Liverpool secured a 2-0 victory over Manchester City, their defensive performance left much to be desired. They faced an exceptional expected threat from City, who frequently penetrated Liverpool's defensive line and found themselves in advantageous positions. Liverpool's defensive actions were noticeably deeper than usual, reflecting a lack of pressure on the ball, resulting in a lower proportion of defensive duels won throughout the match.

Liverpool secured a 2-0 victory against Manchester City, but their defensive performance was surprisingly weak compared to their usual standards. They successfully shut down dangerous opportunities in several areas, particularly avoiding chances from the wings and sides of the box, but still allowed some threats from the right half-space, which could have been costly in a closer match.

Despite Liverpool scoring two goals, they displayed a weak defensive performance against Manchester City, allowing significant expected threat during crucial phases of the match. Their inability to contain the opposition's attack, particularly in the second half, was notable, yet they managed to keep a clean sheet.

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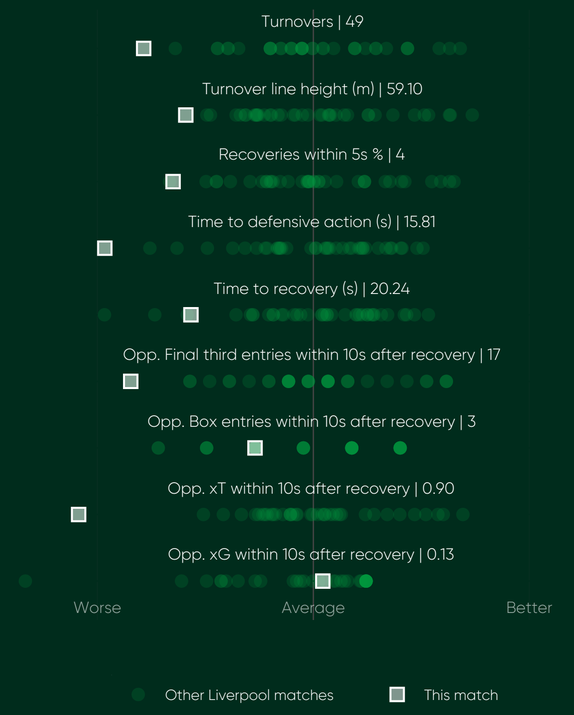
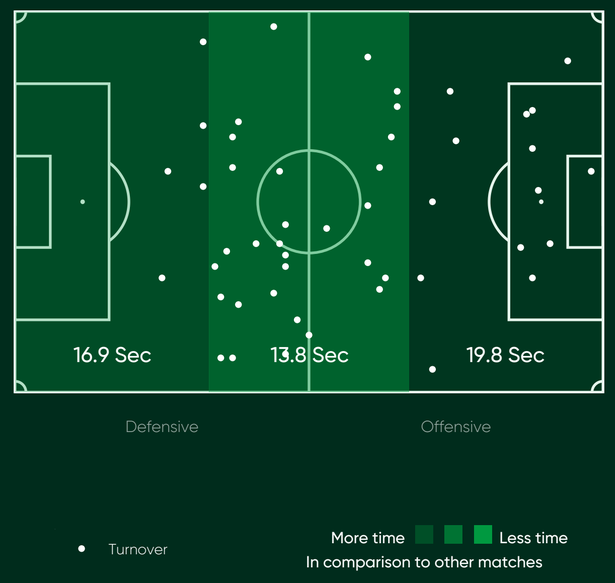
Liverpool's Alarming Defensive Transitions Must Improve

How did Liverpool perform in defensive transition?
Manchester City - Liverpool, 0-2 | 2025-02-23



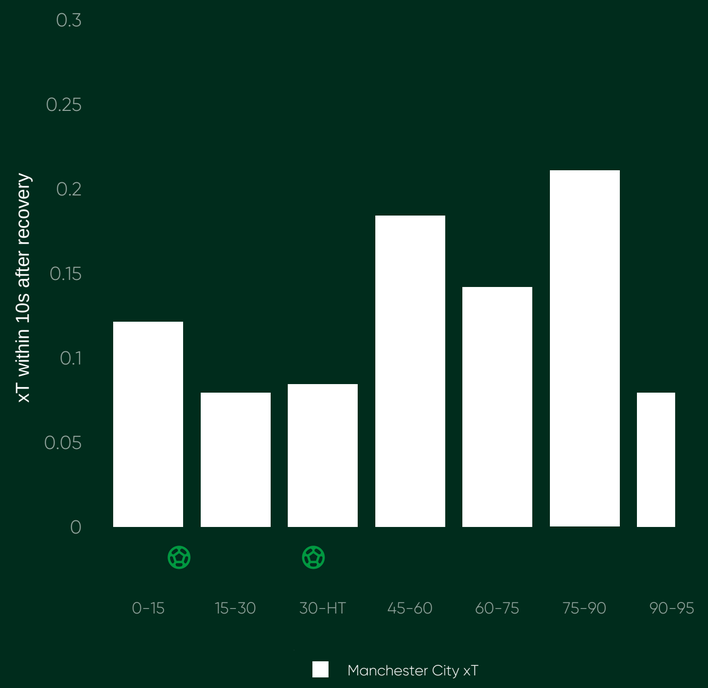
Liverpool's defensive transitions were alarming against Manchester City, as they struggled significantly throughout the match. They lost possession frequently and did so in dangerous areas close to their goal, allowing City to exploit those situations effectively. The opposition created a high number of entries into the final third and had a greater expected threat due to Liverpool's slow recovery times and inability to engage defensively.

How quick were Liverpool to first defensive action?
Manchester City - Liverpool, 0-2 | 2025-02-23



Liverpool's defensive transitions were significantly lacking in their match against Manchester City. They were particularly slow to respond in the final third and their own third, resulting in fewer defensive actions overall. While they were average in the middle third, their sluggishness in key areas contributed to their defensive vulnerability despite the 2-0 victory.

How dangerous were Manchester City after winning the ball?
Manchester City - Liverpool, 0-2 | 2025-02-23



Liverpool experienced significant struggles with defensive transitions relative to their typical performance. Despite not conceding any goals, they allowed the opposition to create numerous dangerous opportunities, particularly early in the second half and towards the end of normal time.

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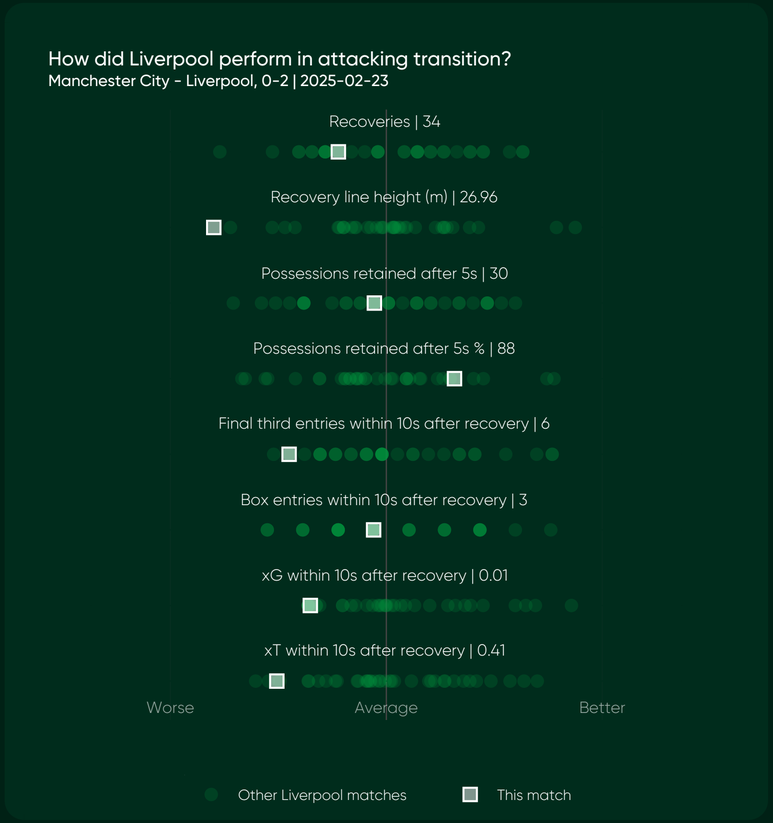
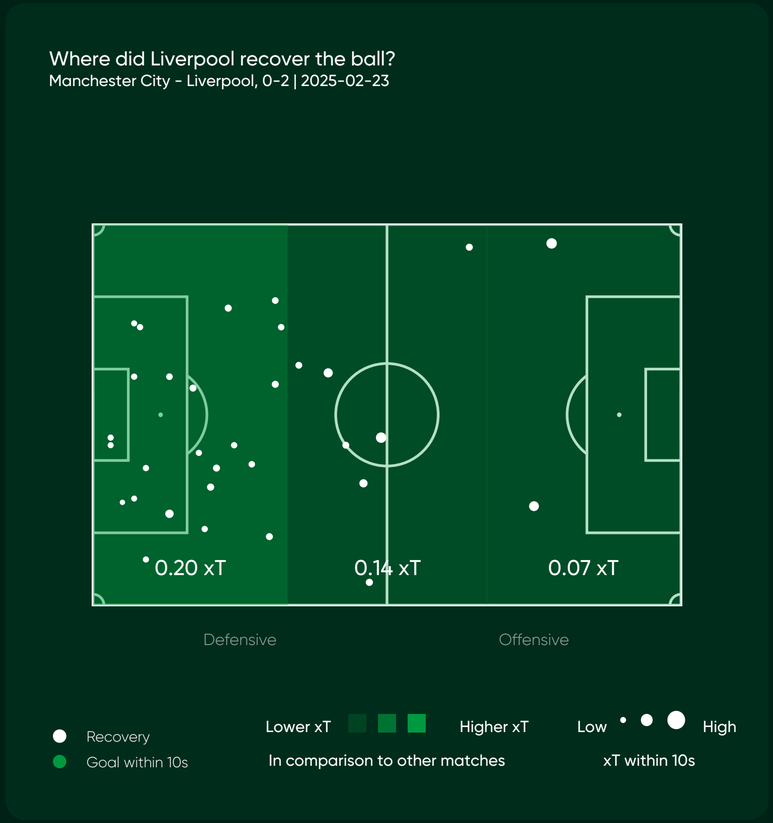
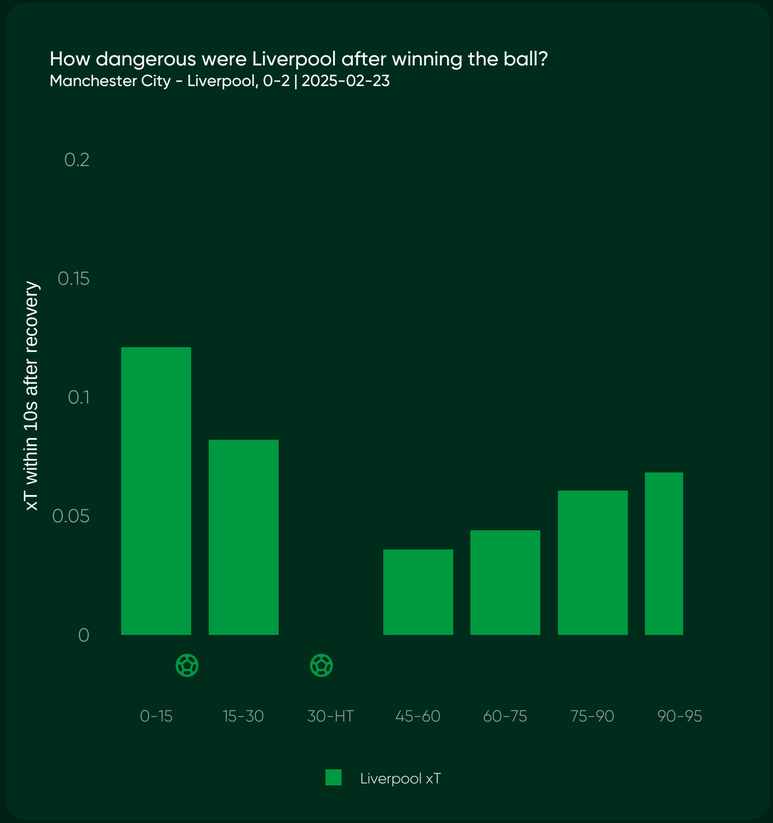
Liverpool's Struggles in Attacking Transitions Persist







Liverpool's victory over Manchester City came despite a lackluster performance in attacking transitions. They struggled to make an impact immediately after recovering the ball, significantly underperforming in expected threat and expected goals within the first 10 seconds of regaining possession. The fact that their recoveries occurred deeper on the pitch further limited their ability to penetrate the final third quickly and create high-quality chances.

Despite their 2-0 victory over Manchester City, Liverpool struggled in terms of attacking transitions throughout the match. They created their typical threat from their own third but fell short in the middle and final thirds, where they generated lower than usual expected threat after recovering the ball.

Liverpool had a subpar performance in terms of attacking transitions despite not conceding any goals. While they found the net twice early in the game, their overall expected threat after recovering the ball was significantly lower compared to their usual standards.

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Liverpool's Attacking Performance Was Below Par

How did Liverpool perform in attack?
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Despite the scoreline indicating a win, Liverpool's attacking performance against Manchester City was below par. They struggled to maintain ball possession and had a significantly lower tempo than usual, which hampered their ability to build up cohesive attacks. Although they managed to convert a high number of their final third entries into the penalty box, the overall lack of possession and final third touches highlighted their inability to sustain pressure.

How did Liverpool get into the final third?
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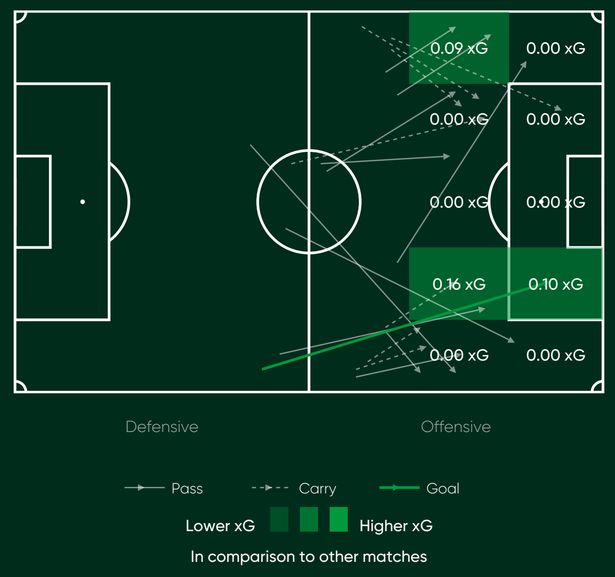

Liverpool won but struggled to create chances throughout the match against Manchester City. They were particularly ineffective in attacking from the flanks and the central areas, with only typical performances from the left and right sides of the box.

How dangerous were Liverpool throughout the match?
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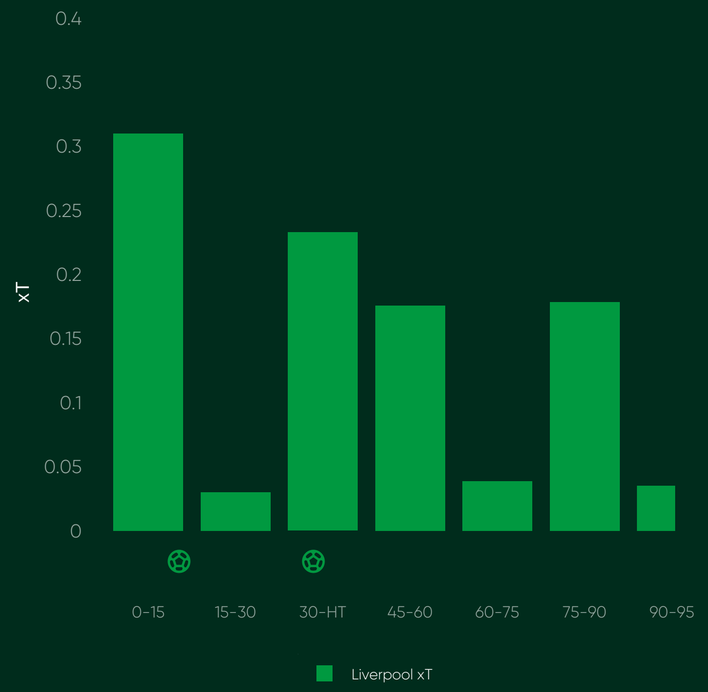

Liverpool's performance was subpar compared to their usual attacking standards, despite scoring two early goals at 14 and 37 minutes. After a strong start to the game, their offensive efforts dropped significantly, generating little threat in the latter stages, including extra time, indicating a lack of attacking momentum throughout the match.

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Liverpool's Chance Creation Lacked Offensive Threat

How did Liverpool perform in chance creation?
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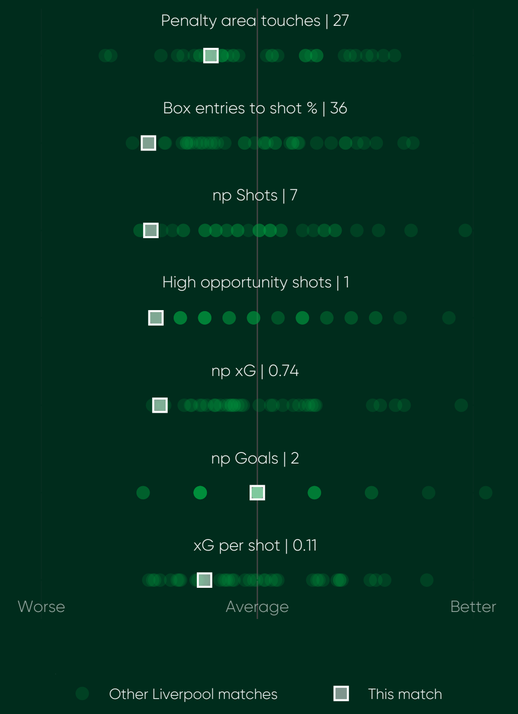
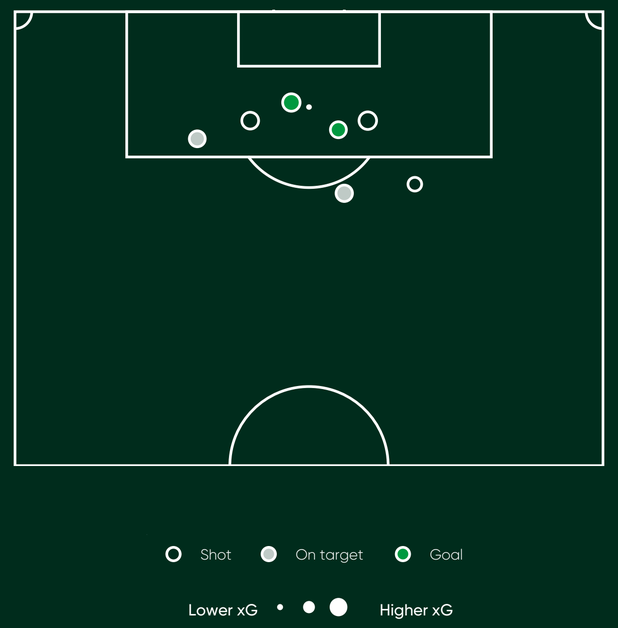


How dangerous were Liverpool's np shots?
Manchester City - Liverpool, 0-2 | 2025-02-23



When did Liverpool create chances?
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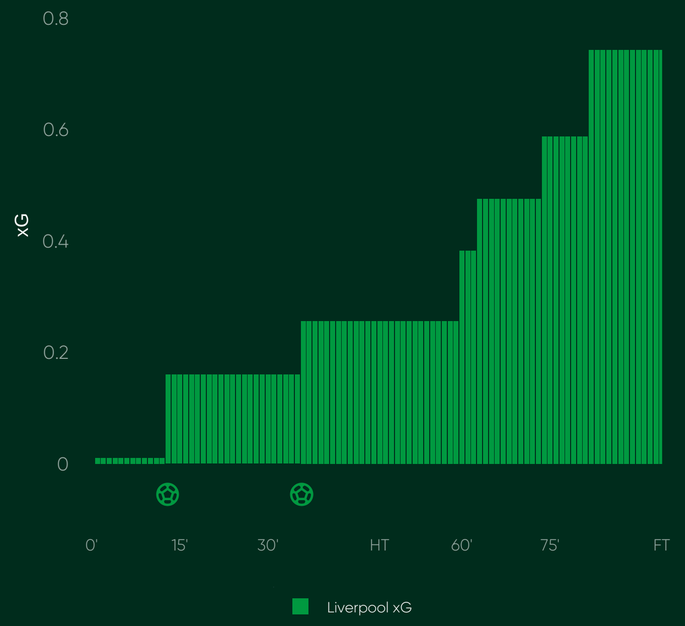

Liverpool's chance creation against Manchester City was below their usual standards despite securing a win. They struggled to convert their box entries into shots, resulting in a notably low volume of attempts, particularly with high-quality chances. Their overall performance in advance of the goal was somewhat underwhelming, yet they managed to take advantage of the limited opportunities they had and capitalized on their finishing ability.

Despite the win, Liverpool struggled to create chances in this match, especially in central areas like the six-yard box and the golden zone. They only managed to generate a typical number of chances when shooting from the left side and outside the box, which highlights their lack of offensive threat.

Liverpool struggled to create significant chances throughout the match, but managed to score from their first two average opportunities. They continued to get more average chances in the second half but failed to convert any further, ultimately reflecting a below-par performance in front of goal.

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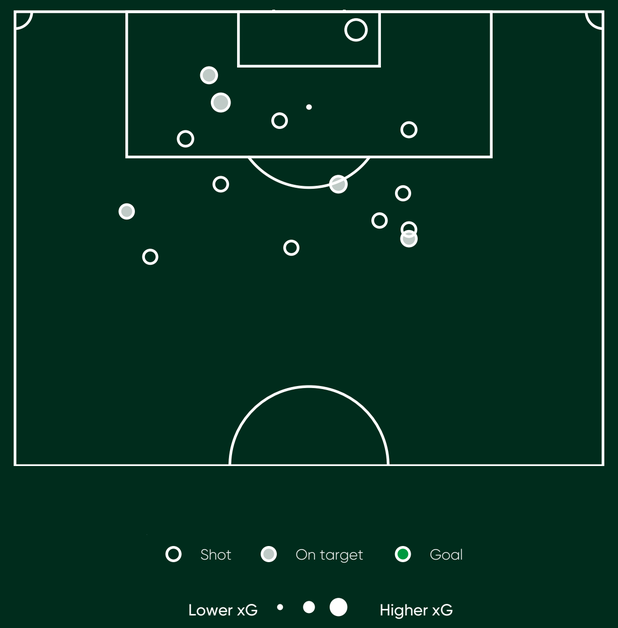
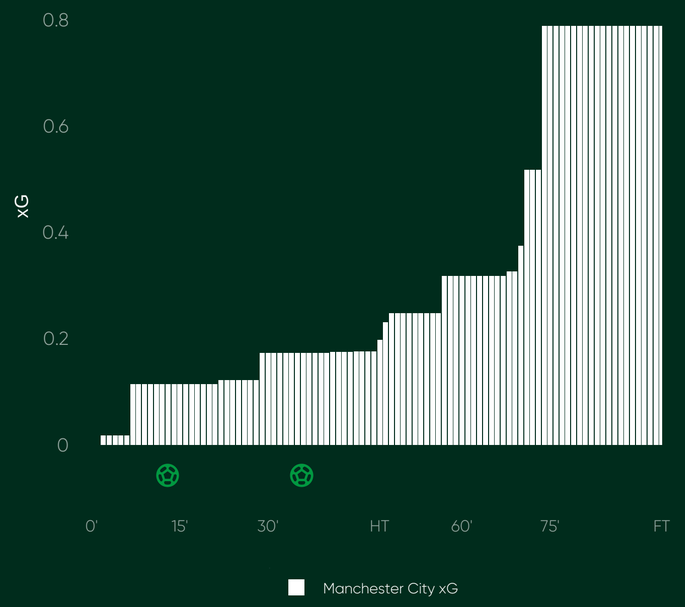
Liverpool's Effective Defense Limits Opposition Chances

How did Liverpool perform in Opposition chance creation?
Manchester City - Liverpool, 0-2 | 2025-02-23

How dangerous were Manchester City's np shots?
Manchester City - Liverpool, 0-2 | 2025-02-23



When did Manchester City create chances?
Manchester City - Liverpool, 0-2 | 2025-02-23



Liverpool's defense effectively contained Manchester City, resulting in a performance that mirrored their usual standards in opposition chance creation. City's expected goals per shot were notably lower than in their typical outings, reflecting Liverpool's ability to restrict high-quality opportunities. Despite City's high volume of non-penalty shots and increased touches in the penalty area, they converted fewer chances, particularly high-opportunity shots.

Liverpool secured a solid 2-0 victory over Manchester City, displaying effective defensive organization throughout the match. While they conceded a typical number of expected goals from various areas, their standout performance came from limiting chances in the golden zone, where they allowed fewer expected goals. However, they did show vulnerability on the right side, where they conceded more chances than usual. Overall, it was a disciplined display that balanced defensive solidity with effective attacking play.

Liverpool's defensive performance mirrored their usual levels of consistency against opposition chance creation. While they managed to deny a couple of good opportunities late in the match, including one that was fairly dangerous, they still demonstrated solid resilience overall, maintaining control until the final whistle.

Glossary

Ball possession %	Percentage of possession of a team.
Box entries to shot %	Percentage of box entering possessions by a team that led to a shot.
Box entries within 10s after recovery	Number of possessions of a team that successfully entered the penalty area within 10 seconds after an open play ball recovery.
Defensive duels won %	Percentage of defensive duels won by a team.
Defensive intensity	Number of defensive actions (duels, interceptions, tackles and fouls) that a team has per minute out of possession.
Defensive line height (m)	Average height on the pitch of defensive actions by a team in open play.
Field tilt %	Percentage of possession that a team had in the final third compared to their opponents.
Final third entries within 10s after recovery	Number of possessions of a team that successfully reached the final third within 10 seconds after an open play ball recovery.
Final third to box %	Percentage of final third possessions by a team that entered the penalty area.
High opportunity shots	Number of non-penalty shots by a team with expected goals higher than 0.15.
Long ball %	Percentage of passes longer than 32 meters in the defensive half by a team.
np Goals	Number of non-penalty goals by a team.
np Shots	Number of non-penalty shots by a team.
np xG	Number of goals that a team should be expected to score statistically in a match considering the quality of their chances, excluding penalties.
Pass tempo	Number of passes that a team made per minute of possession.
Penalty area touches	Number of touches by a team inside the opponent's penalty area.
Possessions retained after 5s	Number of possessions by a team that lasted longer than 5 seconds after recovering the possession of the ball in open play.
Possessions retained after 5s %	Percentage of possessions of a team that lasted longer than 5 seconds after recovering the possession of the ball in open play.
Possessions to final third %	Percentage of possessions by a team that reached the final third.
PPDA	Number of passes of the opponent team in their defensive 60% of the field compared to the number of defensive actions of a team in the same region.

Glossary

Recoveries	Number of ball recoveries of a team in open play.
Recoveries within 5s %	Percentage of ball recoveries made by a team within 5 seconds after losing the possession of the ball in open play.
Recovery line height (m)	Average height on the pitch that a team recovered the ball.
Time to defensive action (s)	Average time that it took a team to make a defensive action after losing the possession of the ball in open play.
Time to recovery (s)	Average time that it took a team to recover the possession of the ball after losing it in open play.
Turnover line height (m)	Average height on the pitch that a team lost the possession of the ball in open play.
Turnovers	Number of times that a team lost the possession of the ball in open play.
xG per shot	Average probability that the non-penalty shots of a team resulted in a goal.
xG within 10s after recovery	Number of goals that a team should be expected to score statistically considering the quality of their chances within 10 seconds after an open play ball recovery.
xT	Expected offensive contribution by a team considering the quality of their passes and ball carries.
xT within 10s after recovery	Expected offensive contribution by a team considering the quality of their actions within 10 seconds after an open play ball recovery.